

Lava to shift operations from China to India

Lava International, citing the government of India's production linked incentive (PLI) scheme, has decided to shift its operations from China to India. The company plans to completely shift its mobile R&D, design, and manufacturing operations to the country in the next six months. As part of the long-term plan, the India-headquartered mobile handset company will invest a total of ₹ 8 billion in the next five years. It is to be noted here that Lava exports over 33 per cent of its phones to markets such as Mexico, Africa, Southeast Asia, and West Asia.

STMicroelectronics joins Zhaga Consortium

STMicroelectronics has become an Associate member of Zhaga Consortium. It aims to advance the deployment of Near Field Communication (NFC) technology in the industrial lighting market. Sylvain Fidelis, head of marketing and application for NFC Tags and Readers, STMicroelectronics says, "With the Zhaga Consortium, the lighting industry is paving the way towards harmonised and interoperable us-

age of NFC technology, driving new opportunities to enhance lighting-equipment connectivity."

Mouser signs global deal with Fortebit

Mouser Electronics has announced signing of a global distribution agreement with Fortebit. The latter is a designer and manufacturer of solutions for embedding voice recognition, speech playback capabilities, and location services. Through the agreement, the Fortebit product line available from Mouser includes the EasyVR 3 Plus speech recognition devices and Polaris vehicle IoT platform.

Volkswagen partners with Northvolt AB for EV battery

Volkswagen has announced that its battery joint venture with Swedish battery producer Northvolt is moving forward and it will start production of lithium-ion cells in Salzgitter in early 2024. Construction of this manufacturing plant is scheduled to commence in Salzgitter in 2020 and production is planned for the beginning of 2024. This facility will come with an annual production capacity of around 16GWh.

PEDA. To be eligible, the bidder should be involved in the business for the minimum last three years in either LED street-lighting projects, solar power projects, or as any SL EPC contractor. The annual turnover of the bidder should have been at least 71 million rupees in each financial year during the last three financial years. The bidder should also be profitable in the last two financial years (2017-18 and 2018-19).

NTPC and ONGC collaborate for renewable energy business

NTPC Ltd, the PSU under Ministry of Power and Oil, and Natural Gas Corporation Limited (ONGC), the PSU under Ministry of Petroleum & Natural Gas, have signed a Memorandum of Understanding (MoU) to set up a joint venture company for renewable energy business. The MoU, as the duo informed, will enable both companies to accelerate their footprint in renewable energy.

The MoU was signed by A.K. Gupta, director (Commercial) NTPC and Subhash Kumar, director (Finance) and in-charge business development and joint venture, ONGC. As per the MoU, NTPC and ONGC will explore the setting up of offshore wind and other renewable energy projects in India and overseas. They shall also explore opportunities in the fields of sustainability, storage, E-mobility and ESG (environmental, social and governance) compliant projects.

NTPC presently has 920MW of installed renewable power projects in its portfolio and about 2300MW of RE projects under construction. With this tie-up, NTPC would accelerate its RE capacity addition programme and

also expand its footprint in offshore wind and overseas renewable energy projects. This will help India's largest power generator achieve its ambitious target of 32GW of renewable energy projects by 2032.

Medical semiconductor segment growing faster

The worldwide semiconductor market, as per a new report by Omdia, is expected to decline by five per cent in 2020, excluding memory ICs. With memory included, global revenue for the overall market will total 439.3 billion dollars in 2020, up 2.5 per cent from 428.5 billion dollars in 2019. This is a significant reduction from the previous Omdia forecast of 5.5 per cent growth for this year.

The medical electronics semiconductor market, as per the report, will total 6 billion dollars in 2020, up from 5.6 billion dollars in 2019. In revenue terms, the ventilator market this year will be worth 4.6 billion dollars, a hefty increase of 71 per cent from 2.7 billion dollars in 2019.

A major growth driver for medical semiconductors will be ventilator equipment used to treat Covid-19 patients. Worldwide, ventilator shipments are projected to reach a total of 691,840 units for the year, up 60 per cent from 430,843 units in 2019.

The medical semiconductor segment will continue to grow faster than the overall industrial semiconductor market in 2021 and beyond, driven by long-term trends such as the aging population, the increasing use of telehealth, the move to portable and wearable devices, and the rise of artificial intelligence (AI).

Apple could shift 20 per cent production to India

Apple is examining a proposal to shift nearly 20 per cent of its production capacity from China to India and boost up its local manufacturing capabilities through its contract manufacturers, as per a report published in The Economic Times. The report also says that it aims to achieve 40 billion dollars' worth of production over the next five years.

The report further adds that sources close to the company's plans said that there are few reservations on the government's production incentive (PLI) scheme. It was recently announced to incentivise local handset manufacturing and exports.

In March this year, the government approved PLI scheme for large scale electronics manufacturing. The scheme includes incentives for players manufacturing mobile phones in India. It also encompasses specified electronic components including assembly, testing, marking and packaging (ATMP) units.

As per the report, officials in the government said that they will look into all the concerns as the centre is focussed on bringing hi-tech manufacturing to India. Prime Minister Narendra Modi met top executives of Apple, Samsung, and Lava on December 28 last year to start the process.

A report by International Data Corporation said that in 2018-19, Apple held a 38 per cent market share of global handset exports. Samsung took second place with a 22 per cent share. A company has to manufacture at least 10 billion dollars' worth mobile phones in a phased manner between 2020 and 2025 to avail of the benefits of the PLI scheme. The applicant has to meet the targets on a yearly basis.